



Malpractice & Maladministration Policy

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1. DEFINITIONS

Malpractice means any deliberate act, default, or irregularity by a learner or member of staff that has, or could have, the effect of undermining the integrity of the assessment process. This includes, but is not limited to, cheating, plagiarism, impersonation, and sharing assessment answers.

Maladministration means any non-deliberate act or omission that results in the assessment not being conducted in accordance with the published Assessment Policy, which has or could have the effect of affecting the validity, reliability, or fairness of the assessment.

2. EXAMPLES OF LEARNER MALPRACTICE

- Allowing another person to complete assessments on the learner's behalf (impersonation).
- Sharing quiz questions, answers, or mock examination content with other learners.
- Using artificial intelligence or automated tools to answer quiz or examination questions.
- Attempting to bypass the Platform's device-locking mechanism.
- Providing false information at the point of activation or registration.
- Recording, distributing, or reproducing any assessment content.

3. DETECTION MECHANISMS

The Platform incorporates multiple detection mechanisms to identify malpractice:

- Device-locking: Each Activation Code is bonded to a single device. Any attempt to access the Platform from a different device will trigger a logout.
- Dynamic watermarking: All video content carries a dynamic on-screen watermark displaying the learner's name and email address, repositioning every 60 seconds to prevent screen-recording obscuration.
- Assessment randomisation: Questions are drawn randomly from a large bank, reducing the utility of answer-sharing.
- Behavioural monitoring: Unusual patterns of assessment completion (e.g., all questions answered immediately with 100% accuracy) may be flagged for manual review.

4. REPORTING MALPRACTICE OR MALADMINISTRATION

Any member of staff, contractor, or learner who suspects malpractice or maladministration should report it promptly to info@chainsawcourses.com. Reports will be treated with confidentiality and investigated promptly. False or malicious reports may themselves constitute malpractice.

5. INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

On receipt of a malpractice or maladministration report, the following steps will be taken:

1. The Director is notified immediately.
2. Platform access for the learner in question may be suspended pending investigation.
3. Evidence is gathered and reviewed within 10 working days.
4. The learner is notified of the allegation and given the opportunity to respond.
5. A decision is made within 20 working days and communicated to the learner in writing.

6. Where malpractice is confirmed, sanctions are applied.

6. SANCTIONS

FINDING	SANCTION
Suspected malpractice (unconfirmed)	Temporary suspension of access pending investigation
Confirmed learner malpractice	Permanent revocation of access without refund; notification to IIRSM where appropriate
Staff/contractor maladministration	Disciplinary action; corrective assessment where learners affected
Suspected impersonation	Referral to relevant authorities if fraud is suspected

7. APPEALS

A learner who believes a malpractice finding is unfair may appeal in accordance with the Appeals Policy. The appeal must be submitted within 10 working days of the finding being communicated.

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